

Microsoft brings Black Duck open source tools to Visual Studio

Microsoft is integrating the automated, open source code management program Black Duck Hub with its Visual Studio package. Black Duck (based in Massachusetts in the US) has also joined the Microsoft Visual Studio Program as a premier level partner.

Black Duck Hub is capable of enhancing the code through software composition capabilities and offers a large amount of data to identify security holes. KnowledgeBase, the database behind Black Duck Hub, includes data on more than 2 million open source projects and over 79,000 known vulnerabilities. This enables the program to scan your code and look for different security issues.

"Microsoft recognises the importance of open source in application development and the many economic and productivity reasons for its rapidly expanding use. We are pleased that Microsoft also sees value in bringing Black Duck's open source licence and security compliance capabilities to the Microsoft Visual Studio continuous integration platform," said Lou Shipley, CEO, Black Duck, in a joint statement.

Black Duck Hub helps you prioritise and track your efforts. Also, the code-checking service will be able to guide you on whether the open source code used in your project has any licensing issues.

The Visual Studio extension of Black Duck Hub scans for open source code in your TFS (Team Foundation Service) and TS (Team Services) builds. It scans the code for security vulnerabilities and other components for licence compliance issues. The tool also allows you to monitor the code written by your employees.

Black Duck and Microsoft are offering Hub support to developers with a 14-day free trial. A video tutorial has also been produced to ease the integration process.

If you do not want to analyse your code on Visual Studio, you can use Black Duck Hub on programming tools developed by IT giants like HPE and IBM. However, Microsoft has also convinced the Black Duck team to join its Visual Studio Partner Program to extend the service access for its integrated development environment.

IBM, Red Hat partner to develop open source hybrid cloud

IBM and Red Hat have announced a strategic collaboration to build an open source hybrid cloud based on OpenStack. The new partnership will persuade enterprise customers to opt for IBM Private Cloud to install the Red Hat OpenStack Platform and Red Hat Ceph Storage.

As a result of this move, IBM and Red Hat will jointly market and sell their cloud deployments. "Our collaboration with IBM is aimed at helping enterprise customers more quickly and easily embrace the hybrid cloud," said Radhesh Balakrishnan, general manager of OpenStack, Red Hat, in a joint statement.

"Now, customers who do not have the in-house expertise to manage OpenStack infrastructure can more confidently consume Red Hat OpenStack Platform and Red Hat Ceph Storage on IBM Private Cloud," Balakrishnan added. Through the latest deal, IBM and Red Hat are set to offer a hybrid cloud infrastructure with OpenStack APIs. Both the companies are also set to enable their clients with a workload migration option directly via Red Hat Cloud Access.

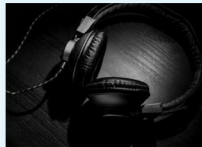
"The strategic collaboration between IBM and Red Hat is designed to enable clients to more easily adopt open source products and OpenStack cloud software while preserving their existing investments and creating new business opportunities," said Zane Adam, vice president for IBM Cloud. IBM has been looking to expand in the cloud space for a long time. The company partnered with Dell EMC-owned VMware last year, and is already running the VMware management platform on its cloud.

Audacity 2.1.3 comes with new scrubbing features

Audacity, the open source audio editing software, has been updated to version 2.1.3. The new maintenance update comes with scrubbing features to ease the editing process.

One of the first changes that you will notice in Audacity 2.1.3 is the Scrub Ruler and Scrub Toolbar to improve the scrubbing experience. There is also a new generator for Sample Data Import, and you can create a higher quality audio file using Change Pitch and Change Tempo effects.

The new Audacity version is powered by the SBSMS algorithm that ensures lossless content and unchanged selection length. There is also an updated click track generator that comes with Swing amount control. In addition to the major new features, the updated Audacity has included a new timer record function. The software also sends you an alert if your system is low on disk space.



Additionally, Audacity has added a function that can save you from accidentally cancelling a recording. There are also tweaks to help you mix MP3 files while exporting.

The Audacity team has developed some new keyboard shortcuts as well. You can easily move to the next or previous label by pressing the **Alt + Right** or **Alt + Left** key combinations. Similarly, the shortcut for **Play/Stop** and **Set Cursor** has been changed from **Shift + A** to just **X**.